IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 24, 2026

Records Undone

Oil surged past $105 as Iran's negotiating team fractured and Israel signaled readiness to resume; defensive sectors carried the tape, Intel's post-close blowout reframes the open.

S&P 500	NASDAQ	BRENT CRUDE	BITCOIN	FEAR & GREED
7,084 ↓0.39%	24,513 ↓0.56%	~$105 ↑4.29%	~$76,700 ↓1.5%	39 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

THE RECORDS UNWOUND ON A SPLIT TAPE — DEFENSIVES LED, TECH SOLD, OIL DOMINATED

Thursday reversed Wednesday's AI-led record run. The S&P 500 slipped 0.39% to roughly 7,084, the Nasdaq fell 0.56% to 24,513, the Dow declined 0.36%, and the Russell 2000 eased 0.35%. UVXY closed down 0.99%, indicating the retreat was controlled rather than panic-driven. The sector dispersion was the session's clearest tell: Utilities (XLU) led at +2.72%, Industrials (XLI) added 1.77%, Staples (XLP) rose 1.67%, and Real Estate (XLRE) gained 1.15% — a textbook defensive rotation. Tech (XLK) absorbed the selling at −1.42%, Discretionary (XLY) fell 1.00%, and Financials (XLF) declined 0.79%. WTI (USO) surged 4.11% and Brent (BNO) jumped 4.29% as the Iran negotiating track fractured and Israel's defense minister publicly signaled readiness to resume the war. S&P futures are modestly firmer overnight per Bloomberg, with Intel's blowout after-close print lifting semiconductor sentiment into Friday's open.

THE EARNINGS TAPE SPLIT CLEANLY — NEE AND ANALOG NAMES RALLIED, FCX AND LMT COLLAPSED ON PRINTS

Five IOWN names reported and the dispersion was exceptional. NEE delivered EPS of $1.09 vs. $0.94 consensus with 2026 guidance of $3.92–$4.02 and an 8%+ long-term CAGR target, sending shares up 6.94% to $96.25 — the portfolio's best performer and a direct rebuttal to Wednesday's Morgan Stanley target trim. FCX posted the cycle's clearest beat-but-sell response: EPS of $0.57 vs. $0.46 on revenue of $6.23 billion vs. $5.84 billion expected, yet the stock collapsed 12.62% to $61.48 as the copper/gold rally that drove the beat proved already priced in. LMT missed at $6.44 vs. $6.77 on revenue of $18.02 billion vs. $18.43 billion consensus and closed down 4.62% to $529.79 on weaker free cash flow. SSNC posted a narrow beat at $1.69 vs. $1.68 but fell 0.88%. ORI missed at $0.68 vs. $0.80 and dropped 5.16%. The through-line: in this regime, the bar is elevated across sleeves, and the tape rewards acceleration, not delivery.

SEMICONDUCTORS FRACTURED — ANALOG BENEFICIARIES RALLIED, AI-CAPEX NAMES DIGESTED

The semi complex split along a specific line Thursday. NXPI surged 6.83% to $241.16, ADI gained 5.89% to $403.88 on a Bank of America target raise to $425, MRVL jumped 5.24% to $165.56 on the Polariton silicon-photonics deal, and KEYS rose 2.23% — the analog and test-equipment cohort carried clean upside. The AI-capex leaders gave back ground: LRCX fell 2.63% to $258.56 after its after-hours pop faded, NVDA eased 1.41% to $199.64, TSM declined 1.23% to $382.66, QCOM fell 1.56%, and CRDO dropped 2.08%. Per Yahoo,

chip market value has added roughly $3 trillion in the recent rally, which some sell-side coverage characterized as historically extended. After the close, Intel reported EPS of $0.29 vs. $0.01 consensus on revenue of $13.6 billion vs. $12.36 billion, guided Q2 revenue to $13.8–$14.8 billion vs. $13.03 billion Street, and shares rose roughly 16% in extended trading per CNBC. Intel is not an IOWN holding, but the magnitude of the beat reframes the AI-capex demand read and could pressure the bear thesis on DRAM, advanced packaging, and hyperscaler spend that sits behind QCOM, NVDA, AMD, TSM, and LRCX.

CRYPTO REVERSED WEDNESDAY'S RALLY — IBIT −1.56%, ETHA −3.53%, HOOD −5.53%

The digital-asset complex gave back a portion of Wednesday's rally as oil pressured risk assets per CoinDesk. IBIT fell 1.56% to $44.05 with Bitcoin near $76,700, ETHA dropped 3.53% to $17.49, COIN declined 4.03% to $197.93, and HOOD fell 5.53% to $83.54 as Wisconsin DOJ expanded the prediction-market regulatory challenge beyond New York. HUT eased 2.44% and MARA slipped 0.34%. Per Bloomberg Intelligence, spot Bitcoin ETF flows turned positive across every rolling period tracked, with IBIT leading at $246.88 million in daily inflows and $3.08 billion year-to-date — the structural bid remains intact even as the equity-proxy sleeve retraced. The pattern reinforces the sleeve's role in the portfolio: structural flows support the position while short-term volatility follows broader risk sentiment.

S&P 500	7,084 · ↓0.39% · Records undone
SECTOR LEADERS	Utilities ↑2.72% · Industrials ↑1.77% · Staples ↑1.67%
SECTOR LAGGARDS	Tech ↓1.42% · Discret. ↓1.00% · Financials ↓0.79%
NEE / FCX / LMT	NEE ↑6.94% · FCX ↓12.62% · LMT ↓4.62%
ANALOG / TEST	NXPI ↑6.83% · ADI ↑5.89% · MRVL ↑5.24%
INTEL AH	+16% · Revenue $13.6B · Q2 guide above Street
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 · Untouched · Intraday low $702.28

A session that inverts a record on an oil shock and rewards long-duration utilities over AI hyperscalers is telling the committee exactly what matters today: the energy-inflation thread and the physical-AI thread are now trading against each other inside the same tape. **The physical world matters.**

Geopolitics

IRAN'S NEGOTIATING TRACK CRACKED — GHALIBAF REPORTEDLY OUT AFTER IRGC INTERVENTION

Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf reportedly resigned from Tehran's US-negotiating team after intervention from the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, per Israeli broadcaster N12 and subsequent coverage from Times of Israel and FXStreet. CNBC has not independently confirmed the report, and Iranian outlets have denied it, but oil markets priced the development immediately — BNO (Brent proxy) advanced 4.29% on the session, consistent with futures trading above the $105 handle per CNBC, as the market read the move as evidence that the IRGC is consolidating control over the negotiating posture. The structural implication is important: Ghalibaf was the civilian-conservative channel that Pakistani mediators had been working with. An IRGC-led negotiating team tightens the demand that the US naval blockade end before any substantive talks resume. For IOWN, the energy sleeve carries this directly — CVX gained 0.69%, VLO eased 0.23% from an already-stretched base, and CTRA added 2.19%. The elevated Brent handle appears to have established a higher trading range.

ISRAEL SAID IT WAS "READY TO RENEW" — DEFENSE MINISTER KATZ SIGNALED TARGETS ARE MARKED

Israeli Defense Minister Israel Katz stated Thursday that Israel is "prepared to renew the war against Iran" and was awaiting a US green light, per Times of Israel, Jerusalem Post, and Euronews. Katz specified that the IDF had marked targets for a campaign that would aim at Iran's energy and electricity infrastructure and senior leadership succession. Reports citing Israeli officials indicated a decision point in Washington was anticipated within days. If taken at face value, the posture is consistent with a late-week escalation window rather than a sustainable de-escalation path. The commodity reaction on Thursday — oil up more than 4%, gold actually softer at –0.97% on dollar strength, silver down 2.83% — suggests the market is pricing supply risk rather than a broad risk-off event. For IOWN's positioning, the defense sleeve (GD –0.63%, LMT –4.62% post-miss) did not function as a hedge on the day; the energy sleeve did. That dispersion is the actionable signal.

THE FED'S APRIL 28–29 MEETING IS NOW FRAMED AGAINST A HOTTER INFLATION PATH

The Fed convenes next Tuesday–Wednesday with no cut priced and the first move still pushed to late 2026 per Tuesday's Reuters poll. JPMorgan Research now expects rates to hold steady through the remainder of 2026, citing the war-inflation leg and resilient labor data. Thursday's initial jobless claims printed at 214,000 vs. 212,000 consensus — a marginal uptick that still leaves claims near cycle lows and is consistent with a labor market that has not yet cracked, reducing the urgency for policy easing. S&P Global's flash composite PMI rose versus March per the press release, driven by stock-building into supply concerns and price hikes — a data structure consistent with cost-push inflation rather than demand strength. The Warsh confirmation process remains stalled with Sen. Tillis conditioning his vote on closure of the Powell investigation, which CNBC noted could leave the position unconfirmed past Powell's May 15 term end. For the committee, the path is directionally clearer: a higher-for-longer rate regime with stagflation tail risk, which rewards the pricing-power names in the dividend sleeve (ATO, NEE, CL, CHD, STLD) and penalizes the multiple-expansion trade that had been pulling Tech higher.

GHALIBAF	Reportedly resigned from Iran's US-negotiating team (N12)
IRGC	Tightening control over negotiating posture
ISRAEL POSTURE	"Ready to renew" · Targets marked (Katz)
BNO (BRENT PROXY)	↑4.29% · Futures above $105 per CNBC · Supply-risk premium rebuilt
JOBLESS CLAIMS	214K · Above consensus 212K · Labor resilience intact
FED MEETING	April 28–29 · Hold priced · First cut pushed to late 2026

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Intel's after-close print is the most consequential AI-tape data point of the week. EPS of $0.29 vs. $0.01 consensus on revenue of $13.6 billion vs. $12.36 billion, with Q2 revenue guided to a midpoint of $14.3 billion vs. $13.03 billion Street, per CNBC and Intel's release. Shares rose approximately 16% in extended trading. The magnitude of the beat validates the AI-CPU and data-center demand cycle that Intel had been lagging on. The read-across for IOWN is specific: the DRAM and advanced-packaging spending thesis underpinning LRCX, NVDA, AMD, TSM, and MRVL is not decelerating. Combined with LRCX's Wednesday guide raise and the analog-cohort leadership Thursday (NXPI, ADI, MRVL), the AI-capex channel is broadening rather than narrowing. Watch how QCOM trades into the open — the Barclays Underweight thesis is the cleanest counter-point to take. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Michigan Consumer Sentiment Final arrives at 10:00 AM ET — the inflation-expectations component is the market-moving line. Consensus centers on the headline index at 47.6 vs. 53.3 prior and the five-year inflation expectation at 3.4% vs. 3.2%. The one-year inflation expectation is consensused at 4.8% vs. 3.8% prior — a material jump if it prints in line. A print above 4.8% would be the cleanest data confirmation that the Iran-war energy shock is transmitting to household inflation psychology, which would reinforce the Fed's higher-for-longer posture and pressure the multiple-expansion trade in Tech. A print at or below consensus may ease some of that pressure on risk assets into the weekend. Baker Hughes rig count follows at 1:00 PM ET. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The FCX drawdown echoes the TEL pattern — earnings beat into positioning, not fundamentals. FCX delivered a clean Q1 print: EPS $0.57 vs. $0.46, revenue $6.23 billion vs. $5.84 billion, record copper prices driving the beat, a $700 million insurance recovery expected in Q2, and $300 million returned to shareholders via dividends and buybacks per the company call. The stock's 12.62% drop to $61.48 signals that the copper-gold rally that drove the beat had already been priced into positioning coming in. That dynamic — beat-but-sell on names positioned into the cycle's upside — now includes TEL on Wednesday and FCX on Thursday. The committee can assess whether the pattern creates an accumulation window in the materials sleeve as copper supply fundamentals remain tight through the commodity cycle. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. NEE's +6.94% print is a notably strong bullish signal for the dividend sleeve. The EPS beat ($1.09 vs. $0.94), 10% year-over-year adjusted EPS growth, FPL retail sales growth of 3.4%, and the reaffirmed 8%+ long-term adjusted EPS CAGR target through 2032 validated the thesis that was under pressure from the rate repricing. Utilities (XLU) led all sectors at +2.72% on the day — a signal that the group is absorbing the higher-for-longer rate path better than positioning had suggested. ATO gained 2.92%, BKH rose 2.95%, and EIX added 1.38%. The rate-sensitive sub-sleeve that had been flagged as a risk in prior briefs has now posted a decisive rebuttal. The through-line: disciplined dividend compounders with structural demand growth (data-center power build, transmission capex) are re-rating faster than the duration mathematics alone would suggest. **The physical world matters.**

5. LMT –4.62% on the miss marks a specific break in the defense-sleeve thesis. LMT reported EPS of $6.44 vs. $6.77 consensus on revenue of $18.0 billion vs. $18.4 billion Street, and free cash flow of –$291 million vs. positive $955 million in the prior-year quarter per the company release. The free cash flow deterioration is the specific item the committee should track: a defense prime's FCF profile should strengthen in a conflict environment, not weaken. The outlook was held rather than raised. GD eased 0.63% to $318.71 in sympathy. The defense sleeve's role in the portfolio — geopolitical hedge with durable compounding — requires the FCF conversion to hold. Q2 will be the reset read. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. Weekend risk framework: Iran escalation window + Fed silent period. Per Israeli media coverage, the Washington decision point on re-engagement could land by the end of the week. US-Iran talks are effectively on hold pending the IRGC-driven negotiating reset. Any weekend escalation (kinetic action, new Hormuz seizures, or a formal talks collapse) would open Monday with an energy-premium gap-up and likely a broad risk-off reaction. The Fed enters its blackout period ahead of the April 28–29 FOMC meeting, removing the speaker-flow that has moderated recent sessions. The week-ahead catalyst stack: Microsoft and Alphabet report Tuesday after close, Meta Wednesday, Apple and Amazon Thursday. IOWN holds none of those names directly but sentiment flow from the hyperscaler reports will set the AI-capex tone that the semiconductor complex trades against. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

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